

AJAY SHARMA

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SUMMARY

- UC Berkeley Statistics and Applied Mathematics graduate with Financial Accounting and Forecasting coursework, interested in strategic finance, retail FP&A, business analytics, overhead spend management, and reporting improvement. Experience in budget-vs-actual variance analysis, Excel/Power BI reports, data queries, and stakeholder presentations.

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Aug 2023 – Aug 2025

B.A. Statistics (*Business Emphasis*), B.A. Applied Mathematics (*Data Science Emphasis*)

Berkeley, CA

- **Relevant Coursework:** Financial Accounting, Forecasting, Business Analytics, Probability Theory, Linear Modeling, Principles & Techniques of Data Science, Concepts in Computing, Modern Statistical Prediction & Machine Learning.

EXPERIENCE

Crestline Risk-Transfer Deal Analysis

Jul 2026 – Aug 2026

Financial Analyst (*Independent Project, Interactive Dashboard ↗*)

Fremont, CA

- Evaluated a proposed \$1.0M risk-transfer deal (50% share, 32.5% commission) by rebuilding 6 years of historical cost ratios from a 4,577-row transaction dataset, deriving a 59% break-even cost ratio to frame the go/no-go decision.
- Identified data-quality failures using accounting identity checks (written = earned + unearned), uncovering 15 erroneous transaction rows, formulaic patterns, missing reserves; found AI-generated memo understated 2 years by 10-21 points.
- Built expected cost ratio forecast (68%, sensitivity band 65-72%) incorporating cost-trend drift and a Poisson-based tail-risk load; presented and defended the methodology to senior stakeholders, recommending restructured deal terms.

BASIS Independent

Aug 2025 – Present

Mathematics Instructor

Fremont, CA

- Earned excellent performance reviews for communication and results while translating complex technical concepts into clear, digestible explanations, helping over 83% of students exceed standards on BASIS network comprehensive exams.
- Built LLM-assisted learning workflows using GPT and Claude to generate practice materials, standardize feedback, and personalize instruction, improving student engagement by 20%+ across two semesters.
- Developed 3 advanced math courses from scratch for 100+ students, creating scalable curriculum, rigorous assessments, and feedback workflows while coordinating with parents and school leadership to improve student outcomes.

BLCK UNICRN

Jan 2025 – May 2025

AI & Financial Analyst Intern

Berkeley, CA

- Analyzed customer and engagement metrics (conversion rate, average session duration) to identify and quantify growth drivers, support product decisions, and improve targeting strategies across 50+ accounts and 120+ contacts.
- Built multi-source data pipeline across 20+ inputs to consolidate and validate actuals, then performed monthly budget-vs-actual variance analysis on KPIs against plan to explain key drivers, reducing manual reporting time by 2 hours/week.
- Designed, iterated, and evaluated LLM prompts (GPT-4o) to improve output quality and accuracy, enabling reliable automated responses for a custom-built chatbot and marketing workflows.
- Authored a Business Requirements Document and workflow documentation to align cross-functional stakeholders on planning, monitoring, and decision-making, ensuring outputs were accurate, timely, and clear for leadership review.

Beats by Dre

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

Data & Consumer Insights Analyst Intern

Fremont, CA

- Analyzed 500+ customer reviews using natural language processing (NLP) techniques in Python, to identify patterns, pain points, product quality and risk signals influencing customer purchasing behavior.
- Cleaned, tokenized, and validated large-scale unstructured review data, ensuring quality and consistency that enabled 10+ distinct visualizations informing tailored marketing campaigns and communication strategy.
- Identified actionable insights on consumer priorities (i.e., sound quality, design, price sensitivity), contributing to a 15% improvement in targeted marketing by refining campaign messaging and alignment with audience profiles.

SKILLS

- **Finance Tools (Proficient):** MS Office (Excel, PowerPoint, Word), Google G-Suite Applications, Power BI.
- **Programming & AI Tools (Proficient):** SQL, Python, LLMs & Prompt Engineering (Claude, ChatGPT).
- **Leadership & Events:** Co-founded American Allegiance of Education; delivered 155-person global hackathon (\$16K sponsorships, 8 judges), owning logistics, communications, competing deadlines, and executive briefings.
- **Interest:** Personal investing, web apps (built S&P 500 Monte Carlo investment simulator), competitive chess (author).